

Business and Technical English Writing (ENG201)

Importance of Courtesy in Workplace Communication

Two years ago I worked as a Team Lead at an office. There was one afternoon that really made an impact on me. We had hired this junior employee not too long before. He made a mistake on a report for a client. It was a minor mistake that could have been prevented if he had more experience. Instead of talking to him about it, a Senior employee started yelling at him in the middle of the workplace. He screamed louder than anyone I've ever heard. The junior employee wasn't allowed to speak. Senior continued to yell at him about how he was a mistake to our team. This caused many consequences. The junior employee lost all confidence and began overthinking. He would no longer talk to us and it caused stress to the workplace. We became divided as a team by sticking up for each other. Later on we found out that it wasn't the junior employees fault. He was not properly trained on the process and his steps were missing information. This experience taught me how lack of respect can destroy a team. Not only did it take away the employees ambition to do his job. It caused confusion between team members. If the senior employee would have handled this like a learning opportunity we all could've moved on from it by fixing the report.

Five Strategies to Maintain Courtesy in Professional Settings

1. Treat Junior Employees with Respect

Senior staff and team leaders should speak politely with junior employees and guide them professionally. Respectful behavior increases confidence and creates a positive working environment.

2. Listen Before Making Judgments

Employees should listen carefully to others before blaming or criticizing them. Understanding the complete situation helps prevent misunderstandings and unfair treatment.

3. Give Feedback in a Professional Manner

Mistakes should be discussed calmly and privately instead of insulting employees in front of others. Constructive feedback improves performance without hurting anyone's self-respect.

4. Use Positive and Polite Language

Using words such as "please," "thank you," and "kindly" helps maintain professionalism and good relationships among team members.

5. Encourage Teamwork and Support

Organizations should promote a culture where employees help and support each other instead of using rude behavior. Teamwork and mutual respect improve communication and workplace harmony.